

Letters that look alike

حُرُوف تَشَابَه

ج ح خ, د ذ, ر ز, س ش, ص ض, ط ظ, ع غ, ف are one body and five sets of dots; so are ق. Write them side by side until the dots are the only thing you need to look at — then put the dots on yourself.

1. Say the sound out loud every single time you write the letter — the hand and the ear learn together.
2. Start at the right and move left. The dots come last, after the body of the letter is finished.
3. Trace the dotted letters first. Then cover the line and write it again on the empty ones.
4. When you can write a letter without looking at the model, go on to the next sheet.

العربي السعودي · Print on A4

SIDE BY SIDE جنب بعض

green = what tells them apart

ا	ب	ت	ث	ن	ي
alif ā · a	bā' b · 6	tā' t · 7	thā' th · 9	nūn n · H	yā' y / ī · ĥ / i

ONE LINE EACH سطر لكل حرف

say the sound as you write it

ا	ا	ا	ا	ا	ا	ا	ا
ب	ب	ب	ب	ب	ب	ب	ب
ت	ت	ت	ت	ت	ت	ت	ت
ث	ث	ث	ث	ث	ث	ث	ث
ن	ن	ن	ن	ن	ن	ن	ن
ي	ي	ي	ي	ي	ي	ي	ي

ALL OF THEM MIXED مخلوطة

look at the dots before you write

ا	ب	ت	ث	ن	ي	ا	ب	ت	ث
ي	ن	ت	ب	ا	ي	ي	ن	ت	ب
ا	ب	ت	ث	ن	ي	ي	ن	ت	ب

ADD THE DOTS YOURSELF خط النقط

the body is written — put the dots where they belong

ا	ب	ب	ب	ن	ي
alif	bā'	tā'	thā'	nūn	yā'

ON YOUR OWN لخالك

write all of them again, from memory

ج ح خ

«حروف» الخَطَّاف · The hooks

One shape, three sounds: dot below, no dot, dot above.

شكل واحد وثلاث أصوات: نقطة تحت، بدون نقطة، نقطة فوق.

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SIDE BY SIDE جَنْبَ بَعْضِ

green = what tells them apart

ج

jīm j · دج

ح

ḥā' ḥ · x

خ

khā' kh · x

ONE LINE EACH سَطْرٌ لِكُلِّ حَرْفٍ

say the sound as you write it

ج

ج

ج

ج

ج

ج

ج

ج

ح

ح

ح

ح

ح

ح

ح

ح

خ

خ

خ

خ

خ

خ

خ

خ

ALL OF THEM MIXED مَخْلُوطَةٌ

look at the dots before you write

ج

ح

خ

ج

ح

خ

ج

ح

خ

ج

خ

ج

ح

خ

ج

ح

خ

ج

ح

خ

ح

خ

ج

خ

ج

ح

خ

ج

ح

خ

ADD THE DOTS YOURSELF حُطَّ النُّقْطُ

the body is written — put the dots where they belong

ح

jīm

ح

ḥā'

ح

khā'

ON YOUR OWN لِحَاكَ

write all of them again, from memory

د ذ ر ز و

حروف ما تتصل باللي بعدها • Letters that never join forward

These never connect to the letter after them, so words break into pieces. I is one of them too. هذي ما تتصل أبد بالحرف اللي بعدها، عشان كذا الكلمة تتقطع. والألف منها بعد.

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SIDE BY SIDE جَنْبَ بَعْض

green = what tells them apart

د

dāl d · ڤ

ذ

dhāl dh · څ

ر

rā' r · ڤ

ز

zāy z · څ

و

wāw w / ū · ڤ / y

ONE LINE EACH سَطْر لِكُلِّ حَرْف

say the sound as you write it

د

د

د

د

د

د

د

د

ذ

ذ

ذ

ذ

ذ

ذ

ذ

ذ

ر

ر

ر

ر

ر

ر

ر

ر

ز

ز

ز

ز

ز

ز

ز

ز

و

و

و

و

و

و

و

و

ALL OF THEM MIXED مَخْلُوطَة

look at the dots before you write

د

ذ

ر

ز

و

د

ذ

ر

ز

و

و

ذ

د

ز

و

د

ذ

ر

ز

و

د

ذ

ر

ز

و

و

ز

ر

ذ

د

ADD THE DOTS YOURSELF حَطِّ الثَّقَط

the body is written — put the dots where they belong

د

dāl

د

dhāl

ر

rā'

ر

zāy

و

wāw

ON YOUR OWN لِحَاك

write all of them again, from memory

Saudi Arabic · write it by hand

اَكْبِتْهَا بِيَدَكَ

س ش have teeth, ص ض have a loop. Heavy letters darken the vowels next to them.

س ش لها أسنان، و ص ض لها حلقة. الحروف الثقيلة تغمق الحركات اللي جنبها.

س ش ص ض

SIDE BY SIDE جنب بَعض

green = what tells them apart

س

sīn s · c

ش

shīn sh · w

ص

ṣād ṣ · c'

ض

ḍād ḍ → z · ʔ'

ONE LINE EACH سَطْر لِكُلِّ حَرْفٍ

say the sound as you write it

س

س

س

س

س

س

س

س

ش

ش

ش

ش

ش

ش

ش

ش

ص

ص

ص

ص

ص

ص

ص

ص

ض

ض

ض

ض

ض

ض

ض

ض

ALL OF THEM MIXED مَخْلُوطَة

look at the dots before you write

س

ش

ص

ض

س

ش

ص

ض

س

ش

ض

ص

ش

س

ض

ص

ش

س

ض

ص

ش

س

ض

ص

ش

س

ض

ص

ش

س

ADD THE DOTS YOURSELF خَطِّ الثَّقَاتِ

the body is written — put the dots where they belong

س

sīn

ش

shīn

ص

ṣād

ض

ḍād

ON YOUR OWN لِحَاكِكِ

write all of them again, from memory

ط ظ ع غ

حروف الحلق · The throat letters

The hardest two days. Go slow and say every sound out loud.

أصعب يومين. خذها على مهلك وقول كل صوت بصوت عالي.

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SIDE BY SIDE جَنْبَ بَعْض

green = what tells them apart

ط

tā' ت · ت'

ظ

zā' ز · ز'

ع

'ayn ع · ع

غ

ghayn gh · ف

ONE LINE EACH سَطْرٍ لِكُلِّ حَرْفٍ

say the sound as you write it

ط

ط

ط

ط

ط

ط

ط

ط

ظ

ظ

ظ

ظ

ظ

ظ

ظ

ظ

ع

ع

ع

ع

ع

ع

ع

ع

غ

غ

غ

غ

غ

غ

غ

غ

ALL OF THEM MIXED مَخْلُوطَة

look at the dots before you write

ط

ظ

ع

غ

ط

ظ

ع

غ

ط

ظ

غ

ع

ظ

ط

غ

ع

ظ

ط

غ

ع

ط

ظ

ع

غ

غ

ع

ظ

ط

ظ

ظ

ADD THE DOTS YOURSELF حَطِّ الثَّقَاتِ

the body is written — put the dots where they belong

ط

tā'

ظ

zā'

ع

'ayn

ع

ghayn

ON YOUR OWN لِحَاكَ

write all of them again, from memory

ف ق ك ل م ه

آخر ستة • The last six

Mostly friendly sounds — and ق, the most Saudi letter of all.
أغلبها أصوات سهلة — ومعها القاف، أكثر حرف سعودي.

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SIDE BY SIDE جَنْبَ بَعْض

green = what tells them apart

ف	ق	ك	ل	م	ه
fā' f · φ	qāf q → g · r	kāf k · κ	lām l · ль	mīm m · м	hā' h · r

ONE LINE EACH سَطْرٍ لِكُلِّ حَرْفٍ

say the sound as you write it

ف	ف	ف	ف	ف	ف	ف	ف
ق	ق	ق	ق	ق	ق	ق	ق
ك	ك	ك	ك	ك	ك	ك	ك
ل	ل	ل	ل	ل	ل	ل	ل
م	م	م	م	م	م	م	م
ه	ه	ه	ه	ه	ه	ه	ه

ALL OF THEM MIXED مَخْلُوطَة

look at the dots before you write

ف	ق	ك	ل	م	ه	ف	ق	ك	ل
ه	م	ل	ك	ق	ف	ه	م	ل	ك
ف	ق	ك	ل	م	ه	ه	م	ل	ك

ADD THE DOTS YOURSELF حُطَّ النُّقْط

the body is written — put the dots where they belong

ف	ق	ك	ل	م	ه
fā'	qāf	kāf	lām	mīm	hā'

ON YOUR OWN لِحَاكَ

write all of them again, from memory

Saudi Arabic · write it by hand

اكتبها بِيَدِكَ